

EMB101

Final Preparation

The relationship between language and employment during the Liberation War of 1971 in Bangladesh is deeply rooted in the socio-political and economic dynamics of the region, particularly in the struggle for linguistic and cultural identity under Pakistani rule.

1. Language as a Tool of Oppression

Under Pakistani rule (1947–1971), the imposition of Urdu as the sole national language marginalized the Bengali-speaking majority in East Pakistan (now Bangladesh). This language policy had significant implications for employment:

Access to Government Jobs: Proficiency in Urdu was often a prerequisite for administrative and civil service positions, effectively excluding many Bengalis.

Educational Disparities: Institutions in West Pakistan prioritized Urdu and English, disadvantaged Bengali students and limited their career prospects.

Economic Marginalization: The language barrier created economic disadvantages for East Pakistanis in federal employment, trade, and business dealings dominated by Urdu-speaking elites.

2. Language Movement as a Catalyst

The Bengali Language Movement of 1952 laid the foundation for a broader nationalist movement. Language became a symbol of:

Cultural Identity: Bengalis demanded recognition of their linguistic heritage as a right.

Economic Justice: The fight for language parity was also a fight for equal access to jobs, resources, and representation.

3. Liberation War and the Vision for Employment Equity

The Liberation War of 1971 was not only a political struggle but also a socio-economic one. Post-independence, Bangladesh aimed to:

Promote Bengali as the Official Language: This allowed wider access to education and employment for the masses.

Equalize Opportunities: New policies aimed to dismantle the Urdu-based elitism in employment and ensure that language would no longer be a barrier to economic mobility.

4. Post-War Reforms

After independence, the use of Bengali in administration, education, and the legal system became a means of:

Empowering the Majority: Ensuring that employment opportunities were accessible regardless of one's fluency in Urdu or English.

Decolonizing the Bureaucracy: Replacing foreign and West Pakistani control with locally educated and linguistically competent professionals.

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Bengali Muslim expectation of advancement through Pakistan in 1947

In 1947, many Bengali Muslims supported the creation of Pakistan with the expectation that it would offer them greater political, economic, and cultural advancement—opportunities they felt were denied under Hindu-majority rule in a united India.

Here are the key expectations they held:

1. Political Empowerment:

Bengali Muslims hoped for more political representation and power within an Islamic state, free from what they perceived as Hindu dominance in British India. They expected

that in Pakistan, their majority status in East Bengal would translate into real influence over national politics.

2. Economic Opportunities:

Many believed that the Muslim-majority areas had been economically neglected under colonial and Hindu-dominated leadership. They anticipated that Pakistan would invest in the economic development of East Bengal, especially in education, employment, and infrastructure.

3. Cultural and Religious Freedom:

There was an expectation that Pakistan would respect and promote Islamic traditions and Muslim identity, providing a cultural homeland free from religious discrimination.

4. Social Upliftment:

Bengali Muslims, many of whom were from lower socio-economic backgrounds, hoped that Pakistan would dismantle the dominance of Hindu landlords and uplift Muslim peasants and workers.

However, reality diverged sharply from these hopes. After partition, East Bengal (renamed East Pakistan) quickly found itself politically marginalized, economically exploited, and culturally suppressed by the West Pakistani elite, especially with issues like the imposition of Urdu as the national language. This ultimately contributed to rising disillusionment and culminated in the independence movement that led to the creation of Bangladesh in 1971.

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Why were six points demanded in 1966?

The Six-Point Movement of 1966 was a political campaign in East Pakistan (now Bangladesh) led by Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and his party, the Awami League. It

demanded greater autonomy for East Pakistan within the framework of Pakistan. The Six Points were presented on February 5, 1966, and are widely seen as the blueprint for the eventual independence of Bangladesh.

The main reasons behind the Six-Point demand were:

1. **Economic disparity:** East Pakistan felt economically exploited by West Pakistan. Despite generating the majority of the country's export revenue (especially from jute), East Pakistan received less in development spending.
2. **Political marginalization:** The central government and military were dominated by West Pakistanis, leaving East Pakistanis with little real power.
3. **Cultural discrimination:** Language and cultural differences were suppressed, most notably during the Bengali Language Movement of 1952.
4. **Demand for autonomy:** East Pakistan wanted control over its own economy, trade, and taxation, as well as a separate militia to protect its interests.

The West Pakistani leadership saw this as a threat to national unity, while for East Pakistanis, it became a rallying cry for autonomy and ultimately independence.

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What led to the war of independence of Bangladesh in 1971?

The Bangladesh War of Independence in 1971 was triggered by a combination of political, economic, cultural, and military factors, mainly centered around the deep-seated tensions between East Pakistan (now Bangladesh) and West Pakistan (now Pakistan). Here are the key causes:

1. Political Marginalization

Language Controversy: Soon after the formation of Pakistan in 1947, Urdu was imposed as the sole national language, sparking protests in Bengali-speaking East Pakistan (the 1952 Language Movement was a key early sign of unrest).

Lack of Representation: Despite East Pakistan having a larger population, political power was concentrated in West Pakistan. The central government repeatedly undermined East Pakistani political leaders.

2. Economic Exploitation

East Pakistan generated a major portion of Pakistan's export revenue (mainly through jute), but it received far less government spending and development investment.

The region suffered economic neglect, worsening poverty, and infrastructural underdevelopment compared to West Pakistan.

3. 1970 General Election and Political Crisis

In Pakistan's first democratic election (1970), Sheikh Mujibur Rahman's Awami League won a majority, mainly due to overwhelming support in East Pakistan.

However, West Pakistani leaders, particularly President Yahya Khan and Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, refused to allow the Awami League to form the government, leading to a constitutional crisis.

4. Operation Searchlight and Repression

On March 25, 1971, the Pakistan Army launched Operation Searchlight, a brutal crackdown on Dhaka and other parts of East Pakistan to suppress dissent.

Widespread atrocities, including mass killings, rapes, and displacement, escalated into a full-scale war.

5. Armed Resistance and Indian Involvement

The Mukhti Bahini (Bengali guerrilla fighters) waged a resistance movement.

Over 10 million refugees fled to India, straining its resources and prompting India to support the Bengali struggle.

India formally intervened in December 1971, leading to a decisive war and the surrender of Pakistani forces on December 16, 1971, resulting in the creation of Bangladesh.

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Role of military and bureaucratic figures in the liberation war of 1971

The military and bureaucratic figures played significant and contrasting roles during the Bangladesh Liberation War of 1971, depending on whether they were from West Pakistan or East Pakistan (now Bangladesh). Here's a breakdown of their roles:

1. Pakistani Military (West Pakistan)

Suppressing Dissent: The military, under General Yahya Khan, launched Operation Searchlight to brutally suppress the Bengali independence movement starting March 25, 1971.

Mass Atrocities: Pakistani military personnel were responsible for widespread killings, rapes, and destruction aimed at silencing opposition in East Pakistan.

Key Figures:

Gen. Yahya Khan: Then-President of Pakistan who ordered military action.

Lt. Gen. Tikka Khan: Nicknamed the "Butcher of Bengal" for his brutal role in Dhaka.

Lt. Gen. A.A.K. Niazi: Commander of Pakistani Eastern Command who surrendered on December 16, 1971.

2. Bengali Military Personnel (East Pakistan)

Defection and Resistance: Many Bengali officers and soldiers in the Pakistan Army defected and joined the Mukhti Bahini (Liberation Force).

Leadership in War: They played a key role in organizing guerrilla resistance and later in coordinating with the Indian military.

Key Figures:

Col. M.A.G. Osmani: Commander-in-Chief of the Mukhti Bahini.

Major Ziaur Rahman: Declared the independence of Bangladesh on behalf of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and fought as a key resistance leader.

3. Bureaucrats (Civil Servants)

West Pakistani Bureaucrats: Generally supported the central government and its policies of repression.

Bengali Bureaucrats: Many refused to serve under the military regime and instead supported the provisional government of Bangladesh (Mujibnagar Government), helping run its administration and diplomacy from exile in India.

4. Provisional Government of Bangladesh

Formed in April 1971 in exile, it was supported by both civilian and military defectors.

Bureaucrats coordinated relief, diplomacy, and media efforts to garner international support.

In summary, West Pakistani military and bureaucrats enforced repression, while many Bengali military and bureaucratic figures defected and became central to the liberation movement.

What does it mean by overvaluation of currency in Pakistan in 1960?

The overvaluation of currency in Pakistan in the 1960s refers to the Pakistani rupee being officially pegged at a higher value than its actual market value or purchasing power. Here's what that means and why it mattered:

1. Fixed Exchange Rate: Pakistan maintained a fixed exchange rate system in the 1960s, keeping the rupee pegged to major currencies like the US dollar and the British pound.

2. Overvaluation Defined: The rupee was overvalued when its exchange rate was set too high—meaning 1 rupee could officially buy more foreign currency than it was truly worth in global markets.

3. Export Disincentive: An overvalued rupee made Pakistani exports more expensive and less competitive abroad, hurting the export sector—especially in East Pakistan (which relied heavily on jute exports).

4. Import Incentive: It made imports cheaper, benefiting the urban elite and industries in West Pakistan, who relied on imported machinery and goods.

5. Regional Imbalance: East Pakistan, which produced export goods like jute, suffered economically because their earnings in foreign currency were converted into fewer rupees. Meanwhile, West Pakistan benefited more from cheaper imports.

6. Economic Grievances: This contributed to economic disparity and was one of the causes of resentment in East Pakistan, eventually fueling nationalist movements.

In short, overvaluation of the currency in 1960s Pakistan favored West Pakistan's economy at the expense of East Pakistan's, deepening regional economic inequality.

OVERVALUATION CALCULATION

Step 1: Real Value Based on Purchasing Power

In the U.S., a burger costs \$5.

In India, the same burger costs ₹100.

So, based on real value (called Purchasing Power Parity, PPP), \$1 should equal ₹20 (because $₹100 \div \$5 = ₹20$).

Step 2: Actual Market Exchange Rate

But in the foreign exchange market, the rate is $\$1 = ₹80$.

Step 3: Conclusion – Overvaluation

If $\$1 = ₹80$ in the market, but in terms of purchasing power $\$1 = ₹20$, then:

The USD is overvalued.

The INR is undervalued.

Simple check:

With ₹100, you should get:

At PPP: \$5 → fair value

At market rate: ₹100 ÷ 80 = \$1.25 → less value

So the market exchange rate gives less value for the INR than it should — meaning the USD is overvalued.

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The nationalism and its theoretical framework during the colonial attacks on language and culture of east Pakistan in 1952

The nationalist movement in East Pakistan (now Bangladesh) during the early 1950s, particularly around the 1952 Language Movement, can be understood through several interconnected theoretical frameworks of nationalism, notably cultural nationalism, ethno-linguistic nationalism, and anti-colonial nationalism. Here's an overview of how these theories apply to the period:

Context: Colonial Continuity in Pakistan

After the partition of India in 1947, Pakistan was created as a state for Muslims, comprising West Pakistan (modern-day Pakistan) and East Pakistan (modern-day Bangladesh). Despite the shared religion, the two wings were vastly different in terms of language, ethnicity, and culture.

West Pakistan's ruling elite attempted to impose Urdu as the sole state language, ignoring the fact that the majority of the population in East Pakistan spoke Bengali. This sparked protests, culminating in the Language Movement of 1952, where several students were killed by police in Dhaka on February 21.

Theoretical Frameworks of Nationalism at Play

1. Cultural Nationalism

Cultural nationalism emphasizes the shared heritage, language, and traditions of a group as the foundation for nationhood.

Application: The Bengali-speaking population began to assert their cultural identity in opposition to the West Pakistani state's attempts to suppress it.

The Language Movement was a defense of Bengali culture, literature, and identity.

Bengali intellectuals, poets, and students saw Urdu imposition as a form of cultural imperialism.

2. Ethno-linguistic Nationalism

This theory sees language and ethnicity as the primary basis for forming a national identity.

Application: The people of East Pakistan began to define their nationhood not by religion alone, but by language and ethnicity.

The slogan "Rashtrobhasha Bangla Chai" ("We want Bangla as the state language") became a powerful ethno-linguistic rallying cry.

It laid the ideological groundwork for the future independence movement.

3. Anti-Colonial/Post-Colonial Nationalism

This form of nationalism emerges in response to colonial or imperial domination, often by a foreign or centralized authority.

Application: Although East Pakistan was technically part of the same nation, the West Pakistani domination resembled colonial rule in many ways (economic exploitation, political exclusion, cultural suppression).

The Language Movement can be seen as a form of post-colonial resistance, rejecting internal colonialism.

Key Ideological Outcomes

The 1952 movement became a symbol of Bengali resistance and sowed the seeds for a broader Bengali nationalist movement.

It helped forge a distinct Bengali Muslim identity, separate from the pan-Islamic identity promoted by West Pakistan.

Eventually, this ideological shift culminated in the Bangladesh Liberation War of 1971.

Explain repressive treatment of west Pakistan over Bengali language in 1952

The repressive treatment of West Pakistan over the Bengali language in 1952 can be understood as a deliberate attempt to impose cultural and linguistic hegemony over the majority Bengali-speaking population of East Pakistan. This repression was part of a broader political and ideological strategy to consolidate national unity under the control of West Pakistan's ruling elite, but it had severe consequences.

Forms of Repression by West Pakistan in 1952

1. Official Language Policy

Urdu declared as the only state language: In 1948, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the founder of Pakistan, stated that "Urdu, and only Urdu" would be the national language of Pakistan.

This ignored the fact that over 56% of Pakistan's population spoke Bengali, not Urdu.

The move was seen in East Pakistan as an act of linguistic imperialism, undermining Bengali identity and cultural heritage.

2. Suppression of Protests

Student-led protests erupted in Dhaka demanding recognition of Bengali as a state language.

On February 21, 1952, police fired live bullets at protestors, killing several students including Salam, Rafiq, Barkat, and Jabbar.

The use of deadly force to silence democratic demands marked a brutal and authoritarian crackdown.

3. Censorship and Political Persecution

Activists, students, and intellectuals who supported the Language Movement were arrested, harassed, or placed under surveillance.

Government-controlled media downplayed or distorted the events to control the narrative and suppress sympathy for the movement.

4. Marginalization of Bengali in Public Life

Bengali was excluded from currency, government documentation, education policy, and military affairs.

Bengali speakers were underrepresented in civil services and the military, despite being the majority of the population.

Impact of the Repression

The violent suppression of the 1952 movement intensified Bengali nationalism.

February 21 became a symbol of resistance and is now observed as International Mother Language Day.

The repression ultimately alienated East Pakistan, planting the seeds for the eventual independence of Bangladesh in 1971.

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Identify how language movement united the people of east Pakistan against the misrule of Muslim league in 1952

The Language Movement of 1952 played a pivotal role in uniting the people of East Pakistan against the misrule of the Muslim League, which was dominated by West Pakistani elites. Here's how the movement fostered unity and political awareness:

1. Shared Linguistic Identity Became a Unifying Force

The people of East Pakistan were ethnically and culturally diverse, but Bengali language was a common thread.

The movement transcended class, religion, and region, bringing together students, workers, peasants, intellectuals, and politicians around a shared linguistic identity.

This unity countered the Muslim League's narrative that religious unity (Islam) was enough to bind East and West Pakistan.

2. Exposure of Political Inequality and Centralized Control

The attempt to impose Urdu exposed the political domination of West Pakistan.

People realized that the Muslim League was ignoring democratic rights and majority voices, revealing the authoritarian and centralized nature of the regime.

The Language Movement highlighted how East Pakistan was being treated like a colony rather than an equal partner in the state.

3. Mobilization of Civil Society and Students

The movement marked the first major political awakening in East Pakistan.

Student organizations like Tamaddun Majlish and East Pakistan Students' Union played a critical role in organizing protests.

The martyrdom of students created powerful symbols of resistance and gave the public a cause to rally behind.

4. Disillusionment with the Muslim League

The Muslim League's refusal to recognize Bengali and its violent suppression of protests led to widespread disillusionment in East Pakistan.

The movement weakened the Muslim League's support base, especially among young people and intellectuals.

It also led to the emergence of alternative political forces such as the Awami League, which would later lead the independence struggle.

5. Rise of Bengali Nationalism

The Language Movement laid the foundation for a distinct Bengali national identity, based on language, culture, and democracy, rather than just religion.

This identity became a powerful tool to unite the masses against West Pakistani misrule.

Conclusion

The 1952 Language Movement was not just about language—it was a political awakening that unified East Pakistanis against the injustice, inequality, and repression imposed by the Muslim League-led central government. It created a sense of collective identity and resistance, setting the stage for future movements, including the struggle for autonomy and, eventually, independence in 1971.

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Identify the causes of economic disparity between east and west Pakistan during 1947-1970

The economic disparity between East and West Pakistan from 1947 to 1970 was driven by a combination of policy bias, resource exploitation, and political centralization. Despite contributing significantly to the national economy, East Pakistan was systematically marginalized in terms of development and investment.

Key Causes of Economic Disparity (1947–1970)

1. Unequal Allocation of National Resources

East Pakistan contributed over 50% of Pakistan's export earnings, primarily through jute exports, but received a disproportionately small share of the national budget.

Development spending and infrastructure investment were heavily concentrated in West Pakistan, leading to economic stagnation in the East.

2. Trade and Export Exploitation

East Pakistan's raw materials (especially jute) were exported through West Pakistan-based companies.

Export earnings were mostly retained and used in West Pakistan, while East Pakistan remained underdeveloped.

This practice created a "colonial-style" economic relationship within the country.

3. Neglect of Industrialization in the East

Industrial development and capital-intensive industries were prioritized in West Pakistan.

East Pakistan remained largely agrarian, with limited industrial base, despite having the potential due to its resources and manpower.

4. Discriminatory Infrastructure Development

Key infrastructure—like roads, railways, ports, and power—were developed in West Pakistan.

The East faced frequent flooding, lack of flood control projects, and poor communication networks.

5. Underrepresentation in Bureaucracy and Military

East Pakistanis were underrepresented in the civil service, military, and policy-making bodies, leading to West Pakistani dominance in economic planning.

Decisions on resource allocation and economic policy were made without regard to East Pakistan's needs.

6. Currency and Banking Policies

Banking institutions were headquartered in West Pakistan, with limited access to credit and capital for East Pakistani entrepreneurs.

Profits from East Pakistan's economic activity were often repatriated to West Pakistan, further deepening inequality.

7. Absence of Regional Autonomy

The centralized structure of governance meant East Pakistan had no control over its own economic policies or planning.

Political efforts to demand autonomy (like the Six-Point Movement led by Sheikh Mujibur Rahman) were a direct response to these economic injustices.

Consequences

Growing frustration and resentment among East Pakistanis.

Strengthened the demand for economic justice and regional autonomy.

Played a critical role in the eventual secession and creation of Bangladesh in 1971.

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How the capitalist development strategy in Pakistan led to regional and income inequality during 1947-1970

The capitalist development strategy adopted by Pakistan from 1947 to 1970 significantly contributed to regional and income inequality, particularly between East and West Pakistan and among different social classes. This strategy, heavily influenced by Western economic models, prioritized growth over equity, industrial over agricultural development, and centralized over regional planning.

Key Ways Capitalist Development Strategy Caused Inequality

1. Growth-Oriented, Not Equity-Oriented Policy

The state's economic focus was on rapid industrialization, mostly in West Pakistan.

Policies were designed to increase overall GDP, but ignored income distribution, especially between regions.

East Pakistan, though rich in resources (like jute), was not included equitably in this growth model.

2. Industrial Concentration in West Pakistan

The government provided generous incentives (loans, subsidies, foreign exchange quotas) to industrialists—mostly based in West Pakistan.

Karachi, Lahore, and other West Pakistani cities became industrial hubs.

East Pakistan remained largely agrarian and underdeveloped, deepening regional inequality.

3. Rise of the “22 Families”

A small group of West Pakistani business families came to control a large share of national wealth through state patronage.

The concentration of capital in a few hands created sharp income inequality within West Pakistan and total economic domination over East Pakistan.

This created a class divide and fueled public anger in both wings.

4. Export Earnings Exploited, Not Reinvested

East Pakistan was the main foreign exchange earner due to jute exports.

However, foreign exchange was used by the central government to finance industrialization in West Pakistan.

Very little of this income was reinvested in East Pakistan, leading to extraction without development.

5. Neglect of Agriculture and Rural Development

The capitalist model favored urban-industrial sectors and large landowners.

Rural areas, particularly in East Pakistan, were neglected, leading to:

Low agricultural productivity

Rural poverty

Lack of infrastructure and services

6. Centralized Planning and Economic Control

The central government controlled economic planning, dominated by West Pakistani bureaucrats and elites.

Provincial autonomy was weak, and East Pakistan had little say in how its resources were used.

This centralized capitalist planning reinforced both class and regional imbalances.

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Explain the 6 points as an economic program to redress the imbalances of the Pakistan development strategy in 1971

The Six Points proposed by Sheikh Mujibur Rahman in 1966 were not just political demands—they were also a carefully crafted economic program designed to redress the deep imbalances created by Pakistan’s development strategy between 1947 and 1971. These points aimed to decentralize power, give East Pakistan economic autonomy, and ensure equitable distribution of resources.

By 1971, these Six Points had become the economic manifesto of the Bengali nationalist movement.

The Six Points as an Economic Program

1. Federal Government with Limited Powers (Only Defense & Foreign Affairs)

Economic Purpose: Shift economic decision-making from the West Pakistan-dominated central government to the provinces.

Impact: East Pakistan would gain control over its own economic planning, allowing it to prioritize local development needs rather than serve central elite interests.

2. Separate Currencies or Financial Systems

Economic Purpose: Prevent the central government from transferring resources and foreign exchange earned by East Pakistan to finance West Pakistan's industrial growth.

Impact: Ensured East Pakistan could retain its earnings, control inflation, and develop its own monetary policies.

3. Power of Taxation and Revenue Collection at the Provincial Level

Economic Purpose: Stop the extraction of East Pakistan's wealth by the central government.

Impact: Allowed East Pakistan to generate and utilize its own revenues for local development, ending decades of fiscal exploitation.

4. Separate Foreign Exchange Accounts for Each Province

Economic Purpose: Protect East Pakistan's share of foreign exchange earnings, mainly from jute exports.

Impact: Prevented the diversion of East's export earnings (which had long funded West Pakistan's industrialization) and enabled local reinvestment.

5. Control Over Trade, Fiscal, and Economic Policies

Economic Purpose: Break West Pakistan's monopoly on trade and industrial policy.

Impact: Gave East Pakistan control over imports, exports, tariffs, and development priorities, allowing for balanced economic growth.

6. Independent Militia or Paramilitary Force

Economic Purpose (indirect): Although mainly a security point, it also aimed to ensure protection of East Pakistan's economic interests and prevent military-enforced economic suppression.

Impact: Enabled East Pakistan to resist future economic domination through coercive force.

Conclusion

The Six-Point Program was a radical shift from centralized capitalist planning to a provincial, self-reliant economic model. It directly addressed the:

extraction of East Pakistan's resources

underinvestment and economic neglect

unequal income and regional development

By demanding economic sovereignty, it challenged the core of Pakistan's exploitative development model and became the blueprint for Bangladesh's demand for independence.

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Explain how bengalee nationalism emerged over the years (1948-1971) from successive people's struggles against the dictatorship and repression of Pakistan

The emergence of Bengalee nationalism from 1948 to 1971 was the result of repeated political, economic, and cultural repression by West Pakistan's ruling elite. Over these two decades, the people of East Pakistan engaged in successive mass struggles that gradually transformed their identity from being part of a Muslim nation to demanding an independent Bengali nation. Each major movement deepened the sense of injustice, resistance, and unity, eventually leading to the creation of Bangladesh in 1971.

Phases of the Emergence of Bengalee Nationalism (1948–1971)

1. 1948–1952: Language Movement – Cultural Repression Sparks Identity

In 1948, Urdu was declared the only state language, despite Bengalis forming the majority of Pakistan's population.

The Language Movement peaked in 1952 when students in Dhaka were killed while demanding Bengali as a state language.

This movement awakened a cultural consciousness among Bengalis, who saw the state's actions as an attack on their language and heritage.

It marked the birth of Bengali nationalism and created martyrs that became symbols of resistance.

2. 1954: United Front Victory and Denial of Power – Political Suppression

The United Front, a coalition of East Pakistani parties, won a landslide victory in the provincial elections.

However, the central government dismissed the elected government, showing its unwillingness to allow East Pakistan self-rule.

This deepened the sense that East Pakistan's democratic voice was being ignored, further fueling nationalist sentiment.

3. 1958–1969: Ayub Khan’s Military Dictatorship – Economic Exploitation

Under Ayub Khan’s dictatorship, centralization of power increased, and East Pakistan’s economic grievances grew.

Although East Pakistan earned most of the country’s foreign exchange through jute, it received far less in terms of development funds.

The rise of the "22 families" of West Pakistan controlling the economy made economic inequality a central nationalist issue.

Discontent led to mass uprisings and protests throughout the 1960s.

4. 1966: Six-Point Movement – Economic and Political Autonomy Demanded

Sheikh Mujibur Rahman launched the Six-Point Program, demanding economic and political autonomy for East

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Analyze how democracy and political and economic aspirations of the majority bengalees could never be allowed within the Pakistan state structure

The failure of Pakistan to accommodate the democratic, political, and economic aspirations of the Bengali majority between 1947 and 1971 was rooted in the structural imbalance of power, ethnic dominance, and authoritarianism embedded in the state’s foundation. Despite forming the numerical majority, Bengalees were systematically

denied equal participation and autonomy—revealing that the Pakistan state structure was inherently biased in favor of West Pakistan's elite.

1. Demographic Reality vs. Political Structure

At independence, East Pakistan had 56% of the total population, giving Bengalees a clear majority in any democratic framework.

However, the ruling elite in West Pakistan feared that true democracy would transfer political power to East Pakistan.

This fear led to the deliberate design of centralized state structures to dilute the influence of the Bengali majority.

2. Language Imposition and Cultural Denial

Early signs of exclusion appeared with the attempt to make Urdu the sole state language, ignoring the majority's mother tongue.

The Language Movement of 1952 was not just cultural—it was a demand for recognition and respect in national life, which was violently suppressed.

3. Centralized Governance and Military Dominance

Power was concentrated in the military-bureaucratic elite of West Pakistan.

Bengalees were grossly underrepresented in the army, civil service, and key institutions.

The state structure was designed to exclude East Pakistan from meaningful participation in governance.

4. Suppression of Electoral Mandates

In 1954, the United Front's electoral victory in East Pakistan was overturned by the central government.

In 1970, the Awami League, representing Bengali aspirations, won a clear majority in Pakistan's national assembly—but power was not transferred.

These incidents showed that democracy was tolerated only as long as it didn't threaten West Pakistani control.

5. Economic Exploitation and Policy Bias

Despite being the main foreign exchange earner (through jute exports), East Pakistan was systematically underfunded.

National development plans favored West Pakistan, reinforcing economic marginalization.

Bengali demands for fair economic treatment—through the Six-Point Program—were viewed as subversive rather than legitimate.

6. Fear of Bengali Autonomy as a Threat to National Unity

Every attempt by Bengalees to seek provincial autonomy was labeled as secessionist.

Instead of engaging politically, the state responded with coercion, arrests, and military action.

The refusal to devolve power revealed that the state structure was built not on inclusion but on control and dominance.

7. 1971: The Final Rejection of Democratic Will

After the 1970 elections, when the Awami League was poised to form the government, West Pakistan's leadership delayed the assembly and launched a military crackdown.

This violent repression showed that the state would rather resort to force than accept Bengali majority rule.

Conclusion

The Pakistan state structure between 1947 and 1971 was fundamentally incapable of accommodating the democratic and economic aspirations of the Bengalees. Through systematic exclusion, political suppression, and economic exploitation, the state undermined its own legitimacy in East Pakistan. Ultimately, this structural denial of democracy and equity led to armed struggle and the birth of Bangladesh.

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Recognize that the war of independence was the culmination of decades of struggle for social, economic, culture, political emancipation of the people of Bangladesh in the liberation war in 1971

The Liberation War of 1971 was not an isolated or sudden event—it was the culmination of decades of Bengali struggle for social, economic, cultural, and political emancipation within the framework of the Pakistani state. From the moment of Pakistan's creation in 1947, the people of East Pakistan (later Bangladesh) faced systematic discrimination, repression, and exploitation, which gradually gave rise to a powerful and unified nationalist movement.

1. Cultural Struggle: Defense of Language and Identity

The Language Movement of 1952 was the first major assertion of Bengali identity.

The attempt to impose Urdu as the sole state language was seen as an attack on Bengali culture.

The deaths of students on 21st February 1952 became a symbol of cultural resistance, and laid the foundation of national consciousness.

2. Economic Struggle: Against Systemic Exploitation

East Pakistan was the economic backbone of Pakistan (especially due to jute exports) but received far less in return.

Infrastructure, industry, and national budgets overwhelmingly favored West Pakistan.

This economic disparity created a deep sense of injustice and deprivation, especially among the rural poor and middle class of East Pakistan.

3. Political Struggle: Repeated Denial of Democratic Rights

From the dismissal of the United Front government in 1954 to the refusal to transfer power after the 1970 election, the political will of Bengalees was systematically suppressed.

The central government, dominated by West Pakistani elites, feared Bengali majority rule and avoided granting East Pakistan autonomy or real power.

4. Social Struggle: Assertion of Dignity and Rights

Bengalees faced marginalization in the civil service, military, and national institutions.

Social mobility was limited by structural inequalities that favored West Pakistanis.

The struggle for liberation was also a struggle for social dignity, equality, and self-respect.

5. Culmination in the Liberation War (1971)

After the 1970 election victory of the Awami League, when the military junta refused to transfer power, it confirmed that democracy could not exist in a united Pakistan.

The brutal military crackdown on March 25, 1971 (Operation Searchlight) aimed to destroy the Bengali nationalist movement.

In response, the people of East Pakistan rose in armed resistance, turning their decades-long struggle into a war for independence.

The war lasted nine months, ending with the creation of Bangladesh on December 16, 1971.

Conclusion

The Liberation War was the inevitable outcome of decades of Bengali resistance to cultural domination, economic exploitation, political marginalization, and social oppression. It was not merely a war of secession, but a revolutionary movement for self-determination, built on the sacrifices and aspirations of generations.

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The nature of the post colonial state of Pakistan after the division in 1947

The post-colonial state of Pakistan after the division in 1947 was characterized by a centralized, authoritarian, and militarized structure, heavily influenced by its colonial legacy and shaped by the interests of the West Pakistani elite. Although born out of a

movement for Muslim self-determination, Pakistan failed to establish an inclusive and democratic state, particularly for its eastern wing (East Pakistan).

Key Features of the Post-Colonial State of Pakistan (1947 onwards)

1. Colonial Bureaucratic Legacy

Pakistan inherited the centralized and hierarchical administrative system of British India.

The civil-military bureaucracy became the dominant force in governance, sidelining democratic institutions.

Instead of reforming colonial structures, the new state preserved and strengthened them to maintain control.

2. Centralized Authority

Power was highly concentrated in West Pakistan, especially in the hands of military and bureaucratic elites.

Provincial autonomy was denied, particularly to East Pakistan, despite its majority population.

The One Unit scheme (1955) merged all western provinces into a single unit to counterbalance East Pakistan's demographic majority, further centralizing power.

3. Weak Democratic Foundations

Pakistan lacked a democratic tradition at its founding and faced frequent constitutional crises.

The first constitution took 9 years (1956) to be adopted and was soon abrogated.

Martial law was imposed in 1958, starting a cycle of military rule and authoritarian governance.

4. Military Dominance

The military emerged as the most powerful institution, overshadowing civilian leadership.

The state became security-focused, justifying repression and centralization in the name of national unity and defense (especially due to tensions with India).

5. Unequal Development and Resource Distribution

Economic planning favored industrialization in West Pakistan, while East Pakistan was neglected, despite generating most export revenue (e.g., from jute).

This led to regional inequality, fueling resentment and nationalist movements in the East.

6. Suppression of Ethnic and Linguistic Diversity

The state promoted a uniform Islamic identity, attempting to suppress ethnic, cultural, and linguistic differences—especially Bengali identity.

This policy alienated non-Punjabi and non-Urdu speaking populations, especially Bengalees, whose Language Movement in 1952 was a direct response.

7. Fragile National Integration

The Pakistani state was unable to forge a coherent national identity, as it prioritized central authority over inclusion.

This led to growing political alienation in East Pakistan, culminating in the 1971 Liberation War and the creation of Bangladesh.

Conclusion

The post-colonial state of Pakistan after 1947 was shaped by authoritarianism, centralized control, military dominance, and economic inequality, rooted in colonial institutions. Rather than creating a participatory and inclusive nation-state, Pakistan evolved into a post-colonial authoritarian state that failed to accommodate its ethnic and regional diversity, ultimately leading to its breakup in 1971.

The post colonial state of Pakistan

"The Post-Colonial State in Pakistan," discussing the formation and dynamics of Pakistan's state after its independence in 1947. The text focuses on how the state was shaped by a powerful alliance of the military-bureaucratic elite, feudal lords, and a bourgeoisie (many of whom migrated from India during partition). Here's a concise explanation:

Mission and Development: The state's mission was to support the "propertied classes" (landowners and capitalists) in Pakistan, fostering a system where these groups thrived. The military-bureaucracy, described as "overdeveloped," became a dominant force, a legacy of British colonial rule.

Key Players: The text highlights a coalition of three groups: Feudal lords, traditional landowners with significant rural power. Bourgeoisie, a capitalist class, mostly migrants from India who settled in urban areas like Karachi. Military-bureaucratic elite, a strong, centralized force that mediated between the other groups.

Class Dynamics: These groups, though small in number, were influential. The "landed bourgeois" (West Pakistani elites combining land and capital) and the military-bureaucracy worked together, integrating Pakistan into a capitalist economy while preserving feudal structures. This alliance mediated the interests of civil classes (non-military groups), maintaining stability.

Historical Context: Post-partition migration from India shaped the bourgeoisie, while the military's dominance stemmed from colonial administrative systems. This created a hybrid system of feudalism and capitalism, leading to concentrated power and inequality.

The handwritten annotations (e.g., circling "military-bureaucratic" and underlining "landed bourgeois") emphasize these key elements in Pakistan's post-colonial development.

